

DEVELOPING A RESEARCH PROPOSAL

CHAPTER THREE

- **After identifying and defining the problem, the researcher must arrange his ideas in order and write them in the form of an experimental plan or what can be described as a research proposal.**

- A research proposal is also known as a:
- work plan,
- prospectus,
- outline,
- statement of intent, or
- draft plan.

A research proposal should address the following basic questions

- 1. What is the problem to be investigated?**
- 2. Is it socially and scientifically important to investigate?**
- 3. What objectives will be achieved through the research?**

- 4. How will the research process be carried out?**
- 4. Who are the potential beneficiaries of the results?**

STRUCTURE / OUTLINE OF A RESEARCH PROPOSAL

- Structure depends upon the intent of the funding agency or the sponsoror.
- The common constituents are:
 - I. Covering page
 - II. Abstract;
 - III. Introduction/Statement of the research problems

IV. Research objectives/hypothesis

IV. justification/key concepts/

IV. Research methods/

IV. preliminary survey of literature

**VIII. Timetable/time schedule or
research plan; and**

VIII. Budget

THE COVER PAGE

- The cover page contains introductory information for the proposal
 - a)** The title of the proposed project or research
 - b)** The name of the researcher /author of the proposal/ or principal investigator/; and the name of the supervisor

**c) The name of the department/
institution;**

c) Presentation date

**NB. Some funding agencies have
standardized cover pages that
may contain additional
information**

Title

- It will immediately attract or lose the interest of any potential donor.
- Fewest possible words
- Waste words' like 'A study on ...', 'An investigation on...', 'An observation on...' should be avoided.

APT TITLE

- A study on the relationship between employee training and job performance in case of Commercial Bank of Ethiopia, Addis Ababa.
- Relationship between training and job performance – A case of Commercial Bank of Ethiopia, Addis Ababa. ---- brief and apt.

Abstract

- It is a short summary of the research proposal. It allows a busy manager or sponsor to understand quickly the thrust of the proposal.
- It should include the following:

- A brief statement of the problem,
- Research objectives/questions and, scope of the research
- Types and sources of data to be gathered for the research

- Research design/ procedure/ to be applied to gather data, tools to be used to analyze the collected data, and the benefits of the approach.

Background of the study

- What the researcher wants to do,
- Why he thinks the work should be done and relate it to what is already known about the problem.
- This part provides some general theoretical basis or justifications for conducting a research.

Statement of the problem

- Discussed already
- Here a researcher has to capture the reader's attention by stating the problem, and its consequences.
- The researcher is expected to state his problem clearly without the use of idioms or clichés. Each word of the statement must be expressive, sharp, and indispensable.

RESEARCH OBJECTIVES

1. *General objective/s/:*
2. *Specific objectives:*
3. *Research questions (if necessary)*

Research objectives

1. *General objective/s/*: These are understood as the overall objectives of the research project;
 - e.g. To study the relationship between training and employee performance

2. *Specific objectives:* These are understood as the elements of the research which are **directly addressable by the methodology** and which are followed in order to achieve the general objectives;

General Objective Splits into Specific Objectives

- e.g. To study the relationship between training and employee performance

- I. To determine if training affects workers' speed at work*
- II. To investigate the impact of training on workers ability of discharging their responsibility properly*

CONTD.

- III. To examine if training affects workers respect for their work*
- III. To describe the relationship between workers' access to training and their productivity*

Research hypothesis

- The researcher has to clearly state a working hypothesis when ever it is necessary.
- **DISCUSSED AT LENGTH ALREADY**

Significance of the research

- This part shows the **explicit benefits and the beneficiaries** of the results of the research being conducted. It states the importance or **contribution** that the study will have **for different bodies.**

Delimitations (Scope) of the study

- Coverage of the study.
- **Delimited to manageable size.**
- In relation to the area coverage as well as to the treatment of the variables in the study.
- In stating the scope, clearly show what is going to be investigated and what not.

Limitations of the study

- This is a part that you will include some **constraints or difficulties** you think that they have **influence** on the results of your study.

- This may be in relation to the:
- weaknesses in the methodology,
- lack of access to data,
- faulty instruments,
- sampling restrictions,
- lack of recent literature in the area etc.

- **Any restrictions or areas of the problem that will not be addressed must be indicated.**

Literature review

- A section in our research that **explains**, **interprets** and **discusses** what has been researched about and documented previously is known as review of related literature.

- **The literature review section examines recent research studies, company data, or industry reports that act as a basis for the proposed study.**
- **Begin your discussion of the related literature and relevant secondary data from a comprehensive perspective, moving to more specific studies that are associated with your problem.**

- **Always refer to the original source to avoid any errors of interpretation or transcription.**
- **Close the literature review section by summarizing the important aspects of the literature and interpreting them in terms of your problem.**

Research methodology

- This describes details of the research design and the procedure to be followed to achieve each research objective.
- It should be sufficiently detailed to enable a scientific assessment of the proposals.

- 1) A brief statement in relation to the **research problems** and **hypothesis** to be tested or **research questions** to be answered;
- 2) A **description** and explanation of the **elements**, **variables** or factors to be measured or otherwise addressed by the research.

3). A description of the **subjects of the study**
i.e. study **population** and **sample or target groups** to be used as sources for data gathering, including explanations of sampling or **selection procedures** or **technique**, sampling units, **sampling criteria**, and **sample size**; and

4). A description of the **types and sources of data**, approaches/methods/ **procedures**/ to be applied in **collecting primary and secondary information**; procedures and **techniques for processing and analyzing** information, and the type of **facilities to be used**.

Reference/ Bibliography

- list of publications he/she actually read and cited in the text-arranged in alphabetical order.
- Use the bibliographic format required by the sponsor.
- If none is specified, a standard style manual will provide the details necessary to prepare the bibliography.

- *For books and pamphlets the order may be as under:*

- 1. Name of author, last name first.
- 2. Title, underlined to indicate italics.

- 3. Place, publisher, and date of publication.
- 4. Number of volumes.
- *Example*
- Kothari, C.R., *Quantitative Techniques*, New Delhi, Vikas Publishing House Pvt. Ltd., 1978.

- *For magazines and newspapers the order may be as under:*

- 1. Name of the author, last name first.
- 2. Title of article, in quotation marks.
- 3. Name of periodical, underlined to indicate italics.
- 4. The volume or volume and number.

- 5. The date of the issue.
- 6. The pagination.
- *Example*
- Robert V. Roosa, "Coping with Short-term International Money Flows," *The Banker, London, September, 1971, p. 995.*

STYLES OF BIBLIOGRAPHY

- e.g.
- **Vancouver style:**
- **American Bibliography style, etc.**

Budget/logistics and Work plan

- *Budget requirement*
- The sources may be from government budget or from supporting agencies.
- Budget breakdown has to be prepared for all activities. It may include the details of:

- **Personal Costs** - Principal researcher-
subsistence and
boarding
- Research assistants-
salary/per-diems
- **Support Services** - Secretarial Costs/
data input and analysis
- **Fieldwork costs** - Transport/ other
relevant expenses/ subsistence

- **Overheads** - Stationery/ photocopy/ printing/ computer media
- **Books/journal costs** - Books and journals tbe purchased
- **Equipments** - Equipment to be bought/ hired (if any)
- **Other relevant costs**